INTERPERSONAL FALSE BELIEF #21 · FRIENDS AND BELONGING

“Nobody really likes me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Being left out, teased, or ignored, especially in childhood or adolescence, can plant the idea that we are unlikable. A few painful experiences can become a lens: a friend who does not text back means dislike, a quiet group means rejection. The belief then shapes behavior. We withdraw, wait to be chosen, or expect the worst, and that can reduce the connection we long for.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said to His disciples, “I have called you friends.” Scripture says, “There is a friend who stays closer than a brother,” and “A friend loves at all times.” God’s thoughts toward you are personal: “How precious to me are Your thoughts, O God, how vast is their sum!” and “The LORD your God is among you… He will rejoice over you with singing.” If the Creator delights in you, then you are not unlikable. Friendship takes time and risk, but the starting point is that you are already known and wanted by God.

> *“No longer do I call you servants, for a servant does not understand what his master is doing. But I have called you friends, because everything I have learned from My Father I have made known to you”* (John 15:15).

Also see

> “A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who stays closer than a brother” (Proverbs 18:24).

> “A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity” (Proverbs 17:17).

> “The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing” (Zephaniah 3:17).

> “Accept one another, then, just as Christ accepted you, in order to bring glory to God” (Romans 15:7).

Common self-statements

- People only tolerate me.
- If I disappeared, nobody would notice.
- Everyone finds me boring or annoying.
- They are being nice out of pity.
- I will always be on the outside.
- There is something unlikable about me.

Common logical errors

- Mind reading: Assuming I know what others think of me.
- Overgeneralizing: Treating a few rejections as proof that nobody likes me.
- Mental filter: Remembering rejections and forgetting kindnesses.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling disliked and concluding that I am.

Challenging questions

- What evidence do I have that someone likes me, even a little?
- Who has been kind to me or reached out?
- Where did I learn that I am unlikable?
- Am I rejecting people before they can reject me?
- What does God say about how He sees me?
- What is one small step toward connection I could take?

Truth summary

> I am not unlikable. Jesus calls me His friend, and God rejoices over me. Some people may not connect with me, but that is not a verdict on my worth. I can take small, steady steps toward friendship.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Friendship
- Loneliness
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love, For Others
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Nobody really likes me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Nobody really likes me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who has been kind to me?
- ☐ What evidence do I have that someone likes me?
- ☐ Where did I learn I am unlikable?
- ☐ Am I pulling away first?
- ☐ What does God say about me?
- ☐ What small step can I take?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus calls me a friend.
- ☐ God rejoices over me with singing.
- ☐ A few rejections do not define me.
- ☐ Friendship grows slowly.
- ☐ Some people do like me.
- ☐ I can take a step toward others.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **John 15:15**
  "No longer do I call you servants, for a servant does not understand what his master is doing. But I have called you friends, because everything I have learned from My Father I have made known to you."
- ☐ **Proverbs 18:24**
  "A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who stays closer than a brother."
- ☐ **Zephaniah 3:17**
  "The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Signs of connection: Each day, write one kind word, text, or smile you received or gave.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, John 15:15 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Jesus has called me His friend, so I am not unlikable.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Friendship" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ List the evidence. Write names of people who have been kind or interested in you.
- ☐ Make a small reach. Send one message or invite one person for coffee.
- ☐ Catch the prediction. Write the thought "they will reject me" and test it afterward.
- ☐ Read John 15:15. Let it remind you who calls you friend.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Nobody really likes me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A connection made
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Nobody really likes me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, You call me friend. Heal the places where I have been rejected. Give me courage to reach out and eyes to see the people who care about me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“I don't fit in anywhere.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Some of us were always a little different: in family, school, church, or work. Moves, culture, temperament, or interests can leave us feeling like the one who never quite matches the room. After enough awkward moments, “I don’t fit anywhere” becomes a settled conclusion.

What Scripture teaches

Paul writes, “We who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another,” and “God has arranged the members of the body, every one of them, according to His design.” Peter says, “You are a chosen people, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for God’s own possession.” “God settles the lonely in families.” Fitting in and belonging are different. A body needs different parts, and your difference is part of how God designed you to serve others. You belong in His family, and He can lead you to places where you are welcome.

> *“But you are a chosen people, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for God’s own possession, to proclaim the virtues of Him who called you out of darkness into His marvelous light”* (1 Peter 2:9).

Also see

> “Just as each of us has one body with many members, and not all members have the same function, so in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another” (Romans 12:4–5).

> “But in fact, God has arranged the members of the body, every one of them, according to His design” (1 Corinthians 12:18).

> “God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land” (Psalm 68:6).

> “Therefore you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God’s household” (Ephesians 2:19).

Common self-statements

- I never match the people around me.
- I always feel out of place.
- There is no group for someone like me.
- I have to change who I am to be accepted.
- I will always be the odd one.
- Everyone else seems to know the rules.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Treating some awkward settings as proof I belong nowhere.
- Labeling: Calling myself “a misfit.”
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling out of place and concluding I do not belong.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never find my people.

Challenging questions

- Where have I felt most like myself, even briefly?
- What interests, values, or gifts do I have that could draw like-minded people?
- What would belonging, as opposed to fitting in, look like for me?
- What do I do to change myself in groups?
- How does God see my differences?
- Where could I try one new group?

Truth summary

> Belonging does not require being the same as everyone else. God made me with a purpose, and He gives me a place in His body. I can look for people and groups where who I am is welcome.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Church
- Friendship
- Gifts, Spiritual
- Self-Esteem, Low

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Truth Be Told — Matthew West featuring Carly Pearce
Honesty about struggles makes room for grace and support instead of pretending to be fine.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
This older hymn pictures Christ's gracious invitation to return rather than hide in shame.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I don't fit in anywhere"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I don't fit in anywhere." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where do I feel at ease?
- ☐ What am I like when I feel most myself?
- ☐ What do I change in groups?
- ☐ What group could I try?
- ☐ How does God see my difference?
- ☐ Who could I ask about their story?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I belong to God's people.
- ☐ God designed me on purpose.
- ☐ The body needs different members.
- ☐ Belonging is not sameness.
- ☐ God settles the lonely in families.
- ☐ I can find my people.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **1 Peter 2:9**
  "But you are a chosen people, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for God's own possession, to proclaim the virtues of Him who called you out of darkness into His marvelous light."
- ☐ **Romans 12:4–5**
  "Just as each of us has one body with many members, and not all members have the same function, so in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another."
- ☐ **Psalm 68:6**
  "God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Where I felt at home: Each week, note one setting or person where you felt at ease.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 12:4–5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Each member of the body belongs, and I belong too.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Loneliness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Map your best moments. List when you felt most yourself.
- [ ] Try one new group. Visit a class, club, church group, or volunteer opportunity.
- [ ] Be curious. Ask one person about their story.
- [ ] Study Romans 12:4–5. Write how your difference helps the body.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I don't fit in anywhere": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A place of ease
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I don't fit in anywhere.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You made me on purpose. Show me where I belong and the people You have prepared for me. Free me from changing myself to be accepted. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

INTERPERSONAL FALSE BELIEF #23 · FRIENDS AND BELONGING

"If people really knew me, they would leave."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

If we have been rejected after being honest, shamed for a mistake, or teased for being vulnerable, we learn to hide. We show a polished version and keep the rest locked away. The result is lonely: people like the mask, and we are convinced they would reject the person behind it.

What Scripture teaches

The psalmist says, "O LORD, You have searched me and known me. You know when I sit and when I rise; You understand my thoughts from afar." God knows everything about you and has not left. Paul writes, "God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us." John says, "If we walk in the light as He is in the light, we have fellowship with one another." Being known, and still loved, is the heart of real fellowship. Not everyone is safe, but the right people can receive the real you.

> *"O LORD, You have searched me and known me"* (Psalm 139:1).

Also see

> "But if we walk in the light as He is in the light, we have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Jesus His Son cleanses us from all sin" (1 John 1:7).

> "A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity" (Proverbs 17:17).

> "But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us" (Romans 5:8).

> "Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous man has great power to prevail" (James 5:16).

Common self-statements

- If they saw the real me, they would be disgusted.
- I have to keep my guard up.
- My past would scare them off.
- They like me only because they do not know me.
- No one could love all of me.
- I must never let anyone see my weaknesses.

Common logical errors

- Mind reading: Assuming I know how others would react.
- Fortune telling: Predicting rejection.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ashamed and concluding that I am shameful.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must reveal everything or nothing.

Challenging questions

- What am I most afraid people would discover?
- Has anyone ever known something hard about me and stayed?
- What is the cost of hiding?

- Who is a safe person I could tell a little more?
- What does it mean that God already knows me completely?
- What small, safe disclosure could I try?

Truth summary

> God knows everything about me and loves me. I do not have to be perfect to be loved. With wise, safe people, I can let myself be known little by little and discover real acceptance.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Confession
- Friendship
- Guilt/Shame
- God, All Knowing
- Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If people really knew me, they would leave"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If people really knew me, they would leave." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I fear they would learn?
- ☐ Has anyone stayed?
- ☐ What does hiding cost me?
- ☐ Who is safe?
- ☐ What is one small disclosure?
- ☐ What does it mean that God knows me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God knows me completely and loves me.
- ☐ Christ died for me at my worst.
- ☐ Fellowship happens in the light.
- ☐ Safe people exist.
- ☐ I can be known gradually.
- ☐ Hiding keeps me lonely.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 139:1–3**
  "O LORD, You have searched me and known me. You know when I sit and when I rise; You understand my thoughts from afar. You search out my path and my lying down; You are aware of all my ways."
- ☐ **1 John 1:7**
  "But if we walk in the light as He is in the light, we have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Jesus His Son cleanses us from all sin."
- ☐ **Romans 5:8**
  "But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Known and accepted: Each week, record one small disclosure and how the person responded.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 139:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God knows me completely and has not left, so I can let safe people know me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Confession" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Name the fear. Write what you are afraid they would discover.
- [ ] Choose a safe person. Pick a trustworthy friend, pastor, or counselor.
- [ ] Share a small thing. Disclose something modest and notice the response.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 139:1–3. Thank God that you are fully known and loved.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If people really knew me, they would leave": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A small disclosure
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If people really knew me, they would leave.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You know me completely and have not left. Give me courage to let safe people see more of me. Heal my fear of being rejected, and lead me to people who receive me with grace. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“Everyone else has real friends but me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Social media, church directories, and group photos make it look as if everyone else has a full circle of close friends. Life changes such as moves, marriage, parenting, job changes, and illness can thin out friendships. The longer we are lonely, the more we assume that others never are.

What Scripture teaches

Solomon observes, “Two are better than one… For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!” Proverbs says, “As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another.” God knows loneliness: the psalmist prays, “Turn to me and be gracious, for I am lonely and afflicted,” and the author of Hebrews urges, “Let us not neglect meeting together… but let us encourage one another.” Many people feel the same ache. Friendship is built, not found fully formed, and God uses ordinary steps to bring friends.

> *“Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!”* (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

Also see

> “As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another” (Proverbs 27:17).

> “Turn to me and be gracious, for I am lonely and afflicted” (Psalm 25:16).

> “And let us consider how to spur one another on to love and good deeds. Let us not neglect meeting together, as some have made a habit, but let us encourage one another, and all the more as you see the Day approaching” (Hebrews 10:24–25).

> “A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who stays closer than a brother” (Proverbs 18:24).

Common self-statements

- Everyone else has a best friend.
- I am the only one who has no one.
- I missed the window for making friends.
- Other people connect so easily.
- I will always be alone.
- No one calls me.

Common logical errors

- Social comparison: Comparing my private life with others’ public moments.
- Mental filter: Noticing the lack of friends and missing existing connections.
- Overgeneralizing: Assuming that everyone else has what I lack.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always be lonely.

Challenging questions

- Is it true that everyone else has close friends? How do I know?
- Who is a casual acquaintance who could become a friend?
- What did my past friendships need to grow?
- What stops me from reaching out?
- What does Scripture say about loneliness and God's nearness?
- What is one concrete step I can take this week?

Truth summary

> Loneliness is common, even when others look connected. Friendships are built over time through small, repeated steps. God sees my loneliness, and He can lead me to friends and use this season for good.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Church
- Love, For Others
- Thankful

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Everyone else has real friends but me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Everyone else has real friends but me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Is it true that everyone else has close friends?
- ☐ Who could become a friend?
- ☐ What stops me from reaching out?
- ☐ What group could I join?
- ☐ What step can I take?
- ☐ How can I pray?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Many people feel lonely.
- ☐ Two are better than one.
- ☐ Friendships grow slowly.
- ☐ God sees my loneliness.
- ☐ I can take one step this week.
- ☐ Community is worth the effort.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:9–10
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"
- ☐ Proverbs 27:17
  "As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another."
- ☐ Hebrews 10:24–25
  "And let us consider how to spur one another on to love and good deeds. Let us not neglect meeting together, as some have made a habit, but let us encourage one another, and all the more as you see the Day approaching."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] A step toward friendship: Each week, write the step you took and how it went.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Ecclesiastes 4:9–10 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Two are better than one, so I will take a step toward a friend.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Loneliness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] List acquaintances. Write five people who could become friends.
- [ ] Invite someone. Ask one person to coffee, a walk, or a meal.
- [ ] Join a recurring group. Commit to a group that meets weekly.
- [ ] Pray about it. Ask God to bring a friend and show you whom to reach out to.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Everyone else has real friends but me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A step toward friendship
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Everyone else has real friends but me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You know how lonely I feel. Bring friends into my life and give me courage to reach out. Help me be a friend as well as find one. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“I have to be useful to be wanted.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Some of us learned that we were welcome when we helped: when we cooked, listened, fixed, drove, or gave. If affection came mostly when we were useful, we learned that our value was our usefulness. As adults, we may say yes to everything, feel panic at being a guest, and quietly wonder whether anyone would want us around without what we provide.

What Scripture teaches

Paul writes, “God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us.” John says, “Love consists in this: not that we loved God, but that He loved us and sent His Son as the atoning sacrifice for our sins.” The LORD “will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love.” Accepted by Christ, we are told, “Accept one another, then, just as Christ accepted you.” God wants you, not just what you do. Serving others is a good thing, but it is not the price of belonging.

> *“And love consists in this: not that we loved God, but that He loved us and sent His Son as the atoning sacrifice for our sins”* (1 John 4:10).

Also see

> “But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us” (Romans 5:8).

> “The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing” (Zephaniah 3:17).

> “Accept one another, then, just as Christ accepted you, in order to bring glory to God” (Romans 15:7).

> “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:14).

Common self-statements

- If I stop helping, they will drop me.
- I must earn my place.
- I am only wanted when I am needed.
- I cannot just be a guest.
- My value is in what I give.
- If I say no, I will be left out.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting rejection if I stop being useful.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either useful and wanted or useless and unwanted.
- Should statements: Insisting that I must always contribute.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling anxious when not helping and concluding I am unwanted.

Challenging questions

- When did I learn that I am wanted for what I do?

- Has anyone enjoyed my company when I was not doing anything useful?
- What would happen if I said no to one request?
- How does God want me?
- What would it be like to receive without giving back?
- Who could I simply enjoy time with?

Truth summary

> I am wanted for who I am, not only for what I provide. God's love was given before I did anything, and I can be with others without earning my place. I can serve out of love, not out of fear of being dropped.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Love, By God
- Servant
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Friendship
- Grace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Weak/Tired

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Songs that speak truth to this belief

This Is Amazing Grace — Phil Wickham
Christ bears the burden of rescue rather than demanding self-salvation.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I have to be useful to be wanted"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

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Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I have to be useful to be wanted." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ When did I learn I am wanted for usefulness?
- ☐ Who enjoys me for myself?
- ☐ What would a no cost me?
- ☐ How does God want me?
- ☐ Can I receive without repaying?
- ☐ Who can I just be with?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God loved me first.
- ☐ I am wanted for who I am.
- ☐ Service is a gift, not a fee.
- ☐ I can receive as well as give.
- ☐ Rest does not cost me love.
- ☐ I can enjoy people without being useful.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 John 4:10
  "And love consists in this: not that we loved God, but that He loved us and sent His Son as the atoning sacrifice for our sins."
- ☐ Romans 5:8
  "But God proves His love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us."
- ☐ Zephaniah 3:17
  "The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Just being: Each week, spend time with someone without doing anything for them and note how it felt.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 John 4:10 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God loved me first, so I do not have to earn my place.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
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6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Notice the pattern. Write when you say yes out of fear.
- [ ] Practice one no. Decline a small request kindly and see what happens.
- [ ] Receive a gift. Accept help or a compliment without repaying it.
- [ ] Read Zephaniah 3:17. Let it settle that God delights in you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

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What I learned: _____

The lie "I have to be useful to be wanted": _____ % My truth: _____ %

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My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I have to be useful to be wanted.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have tried to earn my place. Thank You that You love me first. Teach me to rest in being wanted and to serve out of love, not fear. Amen.

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